ANHDRA LOYOLA INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY (AUTONOMOUS)

(APPROVED BY AICTE. RECOGNIZED BY GOVT OF AP & AFFILIATED TO JNTUK) AN ISO 9001:2015 CERTIFIED INSTITUTE , VIJAYAWADA - 520008

PS - 4
Rules & Guidelines for Open Innovation
(Hardware Category)

1. Build During the Hackathon

- All code, hardware designs, and new features must be created during the 24-hour hackathon.
- Pre-existing open-source libraries, frameworks, APIs, and hardware components (sensors, microcontrollers, kits) may be used, but must be credited.
- No reuse of personal pre-built projects or completed prototypes.

2. Team Rules

- Teams may have up to 4 members (adjustable by organisers).
- No pre-formed “super teams”; forming teams during the event is encouraged.
- Participants should be students or recent graduates (within the last 12 months) unless otherwise specified.
- Organisers, mentors, judges, and sponsors are not eligible to win prizes.

3. AI & Documentation

- Use of AI tools (e.g., GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT) is allowed, but must be transparently disclosed in the README.

- A detailed README must include:
    - Features built during the hackathon
    - Hardware and software used
    - AI tool usage
    - Set up instructions and diagrams

4. Safety & Conduct

- Safety first: no dangerous or high-voltage setups without explicit organiser approval.
- Follow venue rules and maintain safe working conditions.
- Follow the Code of Conduct (harassment, cheating, or unsafe behaviour leads to disqualification).

5. Submission & Demo Requirements

- Public repository with all code, schematics, and README.
- Live demo preferred; if connectivity fails, submit a recorded video showing working hardware.
- 2-minute demo video for judging (YouTube unlisted or Drive).
- 3–5 photos of the physical setup.
- 2–3 minute verbal pitch/demo to judges covering:
    - What was built
    - Technical challenges
    - Live demonstration

6. Judging Criteria (Total: 100 points)

Category	Weight	Focus
Technical Implementation & Complexity	30%	Hardware-software integration, IoT protocols (MQTT, CoAP, BLE), edge/cloud processing, error resilience, real-world IoT challenges
Innovation & Novelty	20%	Original approach, clever combination of tech, creative applications
Functionality & Completion	20%	Full end-to-end system working (sensor processing output), reliability under testing
Design & User Experience	15%	Intuitive interface (dashboard, controls), feedback via LEDs/displays, ease of use
Impact, Feasibility & Sustainability	10%	Real-world value, energy efficiency, cost, security/privacy
Learning & Effort	5%	New skills or tech learned, honest reflection

		on challenges
Bonus (+5 points discretionary)		Exceptional live demo, strong security, creative AI/ML use with IoT, or impressive debugging under pressure.

7. Official Hackathon Rules

- Projects must be entirely built during the hackathon.
- Only credited starter templates, open-source code, or APIs may be reused.
- Teams may use any programming languages, frameworks, hardware components, or IoT kits.
- Use of AI coding assistants is allowed but must be documented.
- Submissions must be the original work of the team.
- Judges' decisions are final.
- Prizes are non-transferable; winners are responsible for any taxes.
- Evidence of pre-built code or unsafe practices = disqualification.

8. Judging Process

- Round 1: Expo-style rotation; judges interact with teams at their setups (10–15 min per judge).
- Round 2 (optional): Live stage demo for top 8–10 projects.
- Scores collected via shared form/sheet; winners announced within 2 hours of judging.
- Judges provide feedback to all teams for encouragement and learning.

9. Notes for Participants

- Focus on a working prototype first; polish is secondary.
- Prioritise integration and reliability over flashy features.
- Demonstrate what you built, challenges faced, and lessons learned.
- Safety and transparency are mandatory; judges may request hardware demonstrations live.

Note: For any queries, kindly contact the following:

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